

TAP vs Tapis

Two different ways to work with TACC HPC systems — a graphical portal you use vs. a programmable platform you build on.



TAP

TACC Analysis Portal

WHAT IT IS

A web portal (browser GUI) for launching interactive sessions on TACC HPC systems.

HOW YOU USE IT

Log in with MFA, then pick a system, app, and queue — it builds and submits the Slurm job for you. No commands.

BEST FOR

Fast, point-and-click access to interactive computing.

EXAMPLES

Jupyter Notebook, RStudio, DCV / VNC remote desktop.

tap.tacc.utexas.edu



Tapis

Science-as-a-service framework, available via Morehouse web interface tenant

WHAT IT IS

An open-source, NSF-funded API framework for securely managing computational work across systems.

HOW YOU USE IT

Write code — REST APIs, the Tapipy Python SDK, or the CLI — to drive jobs, data, and authentication programmatically.

BEST FOR

Building science gateways and automated, reproducible workflows across institutions.

EXAMPLES

Auth, data movement, job & app management, streaming data, containers (v3).

<https://morehouse.tapis.io/#/login>

<https://tapis.readthedocs.io/en/latest/technical/tapisui.html>

Bottom line: TAP is a portal you *use* to get a session in your browser; Tapis is a platform you *build on* to power gateways and automation.